



AN AI IMPRESSION of Salil Parekh (left) and Ashiss Kumar Dash

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AN INSIDER AT THE HELM

Why did the IT major choose Ashiss Kumar Dash to lead its biggest transformation in decades?

BY PALAK AGARWAL

WHEN INFOSYS ANNOUNCED that Ashiss Kumar Dash would succeed Salil Parekh as Chief Executive Officer (CEO) next April, the immediate reaction was to focus on the familiar. Three decades at the company, leadership across multiple businesses, deep client relationships and a long operational track record. However, the appointment raises a far more interesting question.

Artificial intelligence (AI) is

forcing the global information and technology (IT) services industry to rethink how software is built, sold and delivered. Dash's appointment provides a blueprint for what the Infosys board believes the next phase of leadership will require.

The announcement came alongside a strong first quarter performance that underscored the company's position of stability. Infosys reported a 12% year-on-year increase in consolidated net profit to ₹7,769 crore for the quarter

ended June 30, while revenue from operations rose 14% to ₹48,211 crore. The consolidated FY26 revenue was ₹1.78 lakh crore.

In many industries, moments of disruption prompt companies to seek outsiders capable of rewriting the rules. Infosys has done that before. Salil Parekh, the current CEO, himself joined from outside the organisation in 2018, bringing global consulting experience at a time when the company was rebuilding after years of leadership churn.

Infosys today is not searching for stability after a crisis. It is preparing for transformation from a position of strength.

The challenge is no longer fixing governance or restoring growth. It is integrating AI into a company that serves thousands of enterprises across more than 50 countries without unsettling either customers or employees.

That changes what the board looks for in a CEO, according to experts. An insider who understands complexity.

Unlike digital-native technol-